ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

**GRADE 8**

# ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

## PAPER 1 · LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

**MARKS: 70** **TIME: 2 hours**

**Section A: Comprehension – a story and a bar graph (25) · Section B: Summary (10) · Section C: Language in context – advertisement, cartoon and language structures (35). All texts were written by Academic Central.**

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

## INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Comprehension (25 marks), SECTION B: Summary (10 marks) and SECTION C: Language in context (35 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Read ALL the texts carefully before you answer the questions.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise. Use your own words where you are asked to.
6. Spend about 50 minutes on Section A, 20 minutes on Section B and 50 minutes on Section C.

## SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

## QUESTION 1

Read TEXT A and TEXT B and answer the questions that follow.

### TEXT A: Thandeka's Taps

**1** In the village of Ga-Mphahlele in Limpopo, water does not always come out of the tap. Some days the communal taps run dry for hours; on other days a broken pipe floods the road while families wait with empty buckets. For years people complained to each other, but nobody seemed to know whom to tell, or how.

**2** Thandeka Ledwaba, a fifteen-year-old learner at the local secondary school, was tired of carrying water before school. "I used to walk two kilometres to the next tap and arrive at school already exhausted," she says. "One morning I counted: in one week, our tap was broken for four days."

**3** That number gave her an idea. If she could count the problem, perhaps she could also show it to the people who were able to fix it. During a free coding course at the community library, Thandeka learnt to build a simple phone app. She called it TapWatch. With a few taps on the screen, users can report a broken tap or a leaking pipe, add a photo and share their location. Every report is placed on a map that anyone, including municipal officials, can see.

**4** At first, very few people used it. Many older residents did not have smartphones, and others doubted that anything would change. "People said, 'The municipality will never look at a child's app,'" Thandeka remembers. Instead of giving up, she trained a group of learners to visit households and enter reports on behalf of their neighbours. Within three months, TapWatch had recorded more than 600 reports.

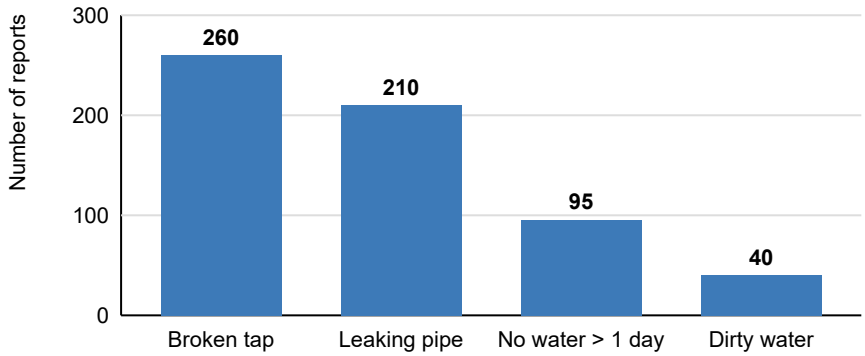
**5** The map told a story that complaints alone never had. It showed that almost half of all breakdowns happened along one old pipeline that had not been replaced in thirty years. When Thandeka and her teacher presented the map at a community meeting, a municipal engineer asked for a copy. Six months later, the old pipeline was replaced.

**6** Today the number of reported breakdowns in Ga-Mphahlele has dropped sharply, and two neighbouring villages have started using TapWatch too. Thandeka has won a provincial science award, but she insists that the prize is not the point. "The app does not fix pipes," she says. "People fix pipes. The app just makes sure that the right people know where to look."

**7** She now spends her Saturday mornings at the library, teaching younger children to code. Her advice to them is simple: "Start with a problem that annoys you. Count it. Then ask what you can build."

*This story was written for this examination. Thandeka and TapWatch are fictional.*

**TEXT B: Reports on TapWatch in the first three months**




**1.1** In which province is Ga-Mphahlele? (1)

**1.2** Give TWO water problems that the people of Ga-Mphahlele experienced (paragraph 1). (2)

**1.3** Why did Thandeka often arrive at school exhausted? (1)

**1.4** "That number gave her an idea." (paragraph 3) Which number is referred to, and what idea did it give her? (2)

**1.5** Explain how TapWatch works. Mention THREE things a user can do. (3)

**1.6** Give TWO reasons why very few people used the app at first. (2)

**1.7** Find ONE word in paragraph 4 that means "were not sure". (1)

**1.8** What does Thandeka's response to this problem show about her character? Give a reason. (2)

**1.9** What did the map show that "complaints alone never had" (paragraph 5)? (2)

**1.10** Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter. The word "sharply" in paragraph 6 means: A slowly B suddenly and by a large amount C painfully D slightly (1)

**1.11** Explain what Thandeka means when she says, "The app does not fix pipes. People fix pipes." (2)

**1.12** Do you think Thandeka's advice in paragraph 7 is good advice for young people? Give a reason. (2)

**1.13** Refer to TEXT B. Which type of problem was reported most often? (1)

**1.14** Refer to TEXT B. How many reports were about dirty water? (1)

**1.15** Refer to TEXT A and TEXT B. Calculate the total number of reports shown in TEXT B, and say whether it supports what is said in paragraph 4. (2)

**[25]**

## SECTION B: SUMMARY

## QUESTION 2

Read the text below. List SEVEN tips that teenagers can follow to stay safe online.

1. Write SEVEN points in full sentences, numbered 1 to 7.
2. Use your OWN words as far as possible.
3. Your summary must not be more than 80 words. Write the number of words you used at the end.

**Safe Online**

The internet is a wonderful place to learn and connect, but it also has dangers. Here is how teenagers can protect themselves. First, create strong passwords that mix letters, numbers and symbols, and never share them, even with friends. Think carefully before you post: a photo or comment can stay online for ever, even if you delete it. Keep personal information such as your home address, school name and phone number private. Remember that people online are not always who they say they are, so never agree to meet someone you have only chatted to online. If someone bullies or threatens you, do not reply; take a screenshot and tell a trusted adult. Be careful with links and attachments in messages from people you do not know, because they may contain viruses or scams. Finally, set your social media accounts to "private" so that only people you know can see your posts.

**[10]**

## SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

## QUESTION 3: ADVERTISEMENT

Study the advertisement below and answer the questions.

**UNLIMITED LEARNING!**

**10 GB of data for only R49***

Stream your lessons. Chat with classmates. Research anything, anytime.

**SpeedLink** – the network that never sleeps!

**Dial *123*49# NOW – offer ends Friday!**

*Data valid between 00:00 and 05:00 only. Expires after 7 days. Terms and conditions apply.

SpeedLink is a made-up company, used only for this examination.

**3.1** Who is the target audience of this advertisement? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

**3.2** Quote TWO words or phrases that the advertiser uses to persuade people. (2)

**3.3** Read the small print. Explain why the heading "UNLIMITED LEARNING!" is misleading. (2)

**3.4** Why do you think the small print is written in very small letters? (1)

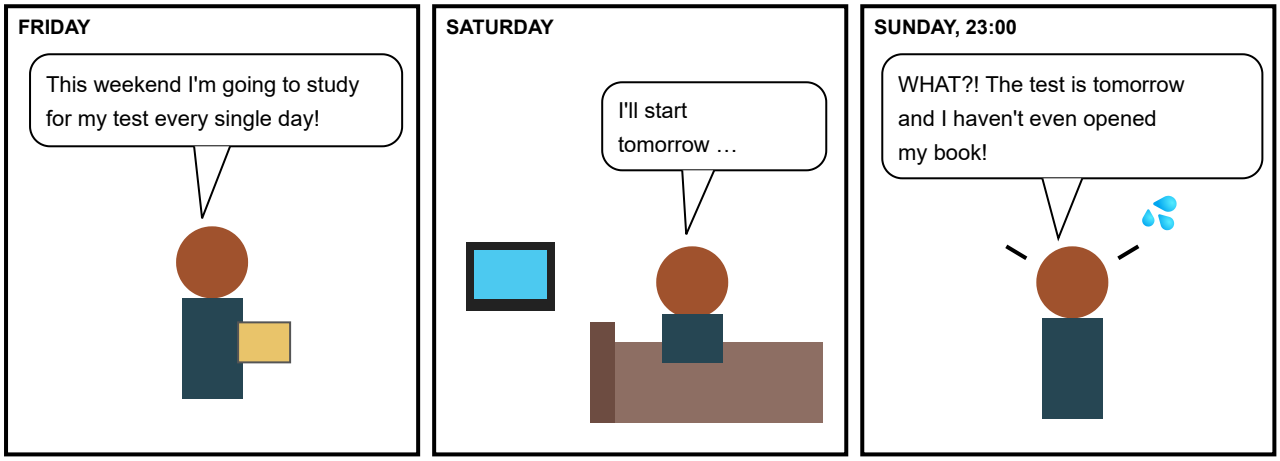
**3.5** "The network that never sleeps" – identify the figure of speech used here. (1)

**3.6** Would you buy this data bundle to study? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

**[10]**

## QUESTION 4: CARTOON

Study the cartoon below and answer the questions.




**4.1** What does the boy promise in the first frame? (1)

**4.2** What does the boy do on Saturday instead of studying? Refer to the picture. (1)

**4.3** Explain what makes this cartoon funny. (2)

**4.4** Choose the word that best describes the boy's feeling in the last frame: relaxed / panicked / bored / proud (1)

**4.5** In which tense is the sentence "I'll start tomorrow"? (1)

**4.6** Rewrite the boy's words in frame 1 in indirect speech. Begin with: *On Friday the boy said that …* (2)

**[8]**

## QUESTION 5: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS

Read the paragraph below and answer the questions. The sentences are labelled (a) to (g).

(a) The school's netball team has won the provincial final. (b) The trophy was presented by the mayor. (c) "We trained every afternoon for six months," said the captain. (d) If it rains tomorrow, the celebration will be held in the hall. (e) The girls, who are all in Grade 8, will receive certificates. (f) Their coach is the most dedicated teacher in the school. (g) Everybody are very proud of them.

**5.1** There is a concord (subject–verb agreement) error in sentence (g). Rewrite the sentence correctly. (1)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **5.2** | Rewrite sentence (b) in the active voice. | (2) |
| **5.3** | Rewrite sentence (a) in the passive voice. | (2) |
| **5.4** | Rewrite sentence (c) in indirect speech. Begin with: *The captain said that …* | (3) |
| **5.5** | Complete this sentence so that it has the same meaning as (d), but about the past: *If it had rained yesterday, the celebration …* | (1) |
| **5.6** | Write down the relative pronoun in sentence (e). | (1) |
| **5.7** | Why is an apostrophe used in "school's" in sentence (a)? | (1) |
| **5.8** | Give the comparative degree of "dedicated" in sentence (f). | (1) |
| **5.9** | Give the noun form of "proud" in sentence (g). | (1) |
| **5.10** | The team was "over the moon" after the final. What does this idiom mean? | (1) |
| **5.11** | Join these sentences using "although": *The girls were tired. They kept on training.* | (1) |
| **5.12** | Rewrite in the plural: *The captain thanked her coach.* | (2) |

**[17]**

**TOTAL SECTION C: [35]**

**TOTAL: 70**

**END OF QUESTION PAPER**